

Harry W. Bass Jr. School of Arts, Humanities, and Technology

Visual and Performing Arts (BA) with Music Concentration

Students who complete the major in Visual and Performing Arts (VPA) pursue an interdisciplinary study of the arts by completing a major core that includes courses in writing, interdisciplinary studies, historical context, theory, and practice. The VPA major culminates in a Senior Capstone. Students who are majoring in VPA can focus their studies by choosing from nine possible concentrations.

The Music concentration allows students to develop a strong musical background through private study of their primary instrument or voice, along with music theory, composition/digital music, and history/literature. Opportunities to perform include solo performance, chamber music and large ensembles. Ensembles are available for voice, harp, guitar, strings, woodwinds, brass, percussion, and mixed chamber groups.

Admission into the university does not guarantee acceptance into the Visual & Performing Arts Music concentration. Acceptance into the Visual & Performing Arts Music concentration depends on completing a successful audition in the primary instrument or voice. Information about auditions, including online submissions, in-person dates, and repertoire options, is available at music.utdallas.edu.

At least one-half of the total semester credit hours for major requirements must be taken at UT Dallas.

Unless otherwise noted, courses in Visual and Performing Arts are open to all students in the University.

Bachelor of Arts in Visual and Performing Arts with Music Concentration

[Degree Requirements](#) (120 semester credit hours)

[View an Example of Degree Requirements by Semester](#)

Faculty

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Professor: Robert Xavier Rodríguez

Clinical Professor: Catherine Parsoneault

Clinical Associate Professor: Linda Salisbury

Professors of Instruction: Kelly P. Durbin, Jonathan Palant

Associate Professors of Instruction: Kathryn C. Evans, Katrina Rushing

Assistant Professors of Instruction: Lori Gerard, Domi Oh, Nili Riemer Bueckert

I. Core Curriculum Requirements: 42 semester credit hours

Curriculum Requirements can be fulfilled by other approved courses from institutions of higher education. The courses listed are recommended as the most efficient way to satisfy both Core Curriculum and Major Requirements at UT Dallas.

Communication: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Communication Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Mathematics: 3 semester credit hours

Select 3 semester credit hours from [Mathematics Core](#) courses

Life and Physical Sciences: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Life and Physical Sciences Core](#) courses

Language, Philosophy and Culture: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Language, Philosophy and Culture Core](#) courses

Creative Arts: 3 semester credit hours

[MUSI 2322](#) Music in Western Civilization¹

Or select any 3 semester credit hours from [Creative Arts Core](#) courses (see advisor)

American History: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [American History Core](#) courses

Government/Political Science: 6 semester credit hours

Select any 6 semester credit hours from [Government/Political Science Core](#) courses (see advisor)

Social and Behavioral Sciences: 3 semester credit hours

Select any 3 semester credit hours from [Social and Behavioral Sciences Core](#) courses

Component Area Option: 6 semester credit hours

[MUSI 2321](#) Music Cultures of the World¹

Or select any 6 semester credit hours from [Component Area Option Core](#) courses

II. Major Requirements: 61-67 semester credit hours beyond Core Curriculum

Lower-Division Preparatory Music History/Theory Courses: 10-16 semester credit hours beyond Core Curriculum

[AHTC 1100](#) First Year Seminar (First-time-in-college freshmen are required to take in their first semester)

or [AHTC 2100](#) Student Success Seminar (Transfer students are required to take in their first semester)

[MUSI 2321](#) Music Cultures of the World¹

[MUSI 2322](#) Music in Western Civilization¹

[MUSI 2328](#) Music Theory I

[MUSI 2329](#) Music Theory II

[MUSI 2330](#) Music Theory III

Upper-Division Required Music History/Theory Courses: 9 semester credit hours

[MUSI 3328](#) Advanced Theory and Keyboard Skills

[MUSI 3330](#) Music Literature: Romantic to Modern

[MUSI 3331](#) Music Literature: Baroque and Classic Eras

Upper-Division Music History/Theory Elective Courses: 6 semester credit hours

Select 6 semester credit hours of upper-division Music History/Theory elective courses:

[MUSI 3322](#) Music in Historical Context

[MUSI 3324](#) Jazz History: Roots to Swing

[MUSI 3325](#) Jazz History: Modern Jazz since BeBop

[MUSI 3327](#) Music in Modern Culture

[MUSI 3342](#) Topics in Music

[MUSI 3389](#) Digital Music II

[MUSI 4348](#) Creating Music

Applied Music and Ensemble Required Courses: 24 semester credit hours

16 semester credit hours of Applied Music courses in primary instrument or voice (at least 8 semester credit hours must be upper-division)

8 semester credit hours of any 1 semester credit hour upper-division MUSI ensemble participation. Placement by audition.

Visual and Performing Art Requirements: 12 semester credit hours

[VPAS 3340](#) Writing in the Arts

[VPAS 4389](#) Theory and Practice of the Visual and Performing Arts

[VPAS 4390](#) Senior Capstone

or [VPAS 4V99](#) Senior Honors in Visual and Performing Art

3 semester credit hours of upper-division Related Courses from the Harry W. Bass Jr. School of Arts, Humanities, and Technology (excluding the MUSI prefix)

III. Elective Requirements: 11-17 semester credit hours

Free Electives: 11-17 semester credit hours

Both upper- and lower-division courses may be used as electives. Students may enroll in courses in other performance areas, such as dance and theatre, complete a minor of their choice, or select additional music courses such as training in a second instrument/voice focus, or additional training in music history or music theory.

The plan must include sufficient upper-division courses to total 45 upper-division semester credit hours.

Minors

Students must take a minimum of 18 semester credit hours for the minor. Students who take a minor will be expected to meet the normal prerequisites in courses making up the minor, and should maintain a minimum GPA of 2.000 on a 4.00 scale (C average). Semester credit hours may not be used to satisfy both the major and minor requirements; however, free elective semester

credit hours or major preparatory classes may be used to satisfy the minor. Core courses offered by the school may count as lower-division semester credit hours toward the minor. Topics courses must be approved by the school. The Harry W. Bass Jr. School of Arts, Humanities, and Technology will substitute courses as necessary. At least one-third of the semester credit hours for a minor must be taken at The University of Texas at Dallas.

Minor in Audio Production

18 semester credit hours

Required Lower-division Courses: (6 semester credit hours)

All students must take the following audio production course:

[ATCM 2345](#) Introduction to Audio Production

And one of the following music courses:¹

[MUSI 2328](#) Music Theory I

[MUSI 2329](#) Music Theory II

[MUSI 2330](#) Music Theory III

[MUSI 2319](#) Digital Music I

Required Upper-division Courses: (12 semester credit hours)

Choose one course from the following: (3 semester credit hours)

[MUSI 3322](#) Music in Historical Context

[MUSI 3327](#) Music in Modern Culture

[MUSI 3330](#) Music Literature: Romantic to Modern

Choose three courses from the following: (9 semester credit hours)

[ATCM 3372](#) Sound Design for Games

[ATCM 3373](#) Location Audio Recording Techniques

[ATCM 3347](#) Recording Studio Techniques I

[ATCM 4347](#) Recording Studio Techniques II

[ATCM 3345](#) Sound Art

[ATCM 4345](#) Sound Synthesis

[ATCM 3346](#) Audio Post-Production I

[ATCM 4346](#) Audio Post-Production II

[MUSI 3328](#) Advanced Theory and Keyboard Skills

[MUSI 3389](#) Digital Music II

[MUSI 4348](#) Creating Music

1. Students may use only one lower-division music theory course for the minor

Minor in Music

18 semester credit hours

6-9 Lower-Division Semester Credit Hours; 9-12 Upper-Division Semester Credit Hours

Required Lower-Division Courses: 6 semester credit hours

[MUSI 2322](#) Music in Western Civilization

[MUSI 2328](#) Music Theory I ^{2, 3}

or [MUSI 2329](#) Music Theory II ^{2, 3}

or [MUSI 2330](#) Music Theory III ^{2, 3}

Additional Music History and Music Theory Courses: 6 semester credit hours total

Choose from the following:

[MUSI 2321](#) Music Cultures of the World

[MUSI 3322](#) Music in Historical Context

[MUSI 3324](#) Jazz History: Roots to Swing

[MUSI 3325](#) Jazz History: Modern Jazz since BeBop

[MUSI 3327](#) Music in Modern Culture

[MUSI 3328](#) Advanced Theory and Keyboard Skills

[MUSI 3330](#) Music Literature: Romantic to Modern

[MUSI 3331](#) Music Literature: Baroque and Classic Eras

[MUSI 3342](#) Topics in Music

[MUSI 3389](#) Digital Music II

[MUSI 4348](#) Creating Music

Upper-Division Music Performance and/or Ensemble courses: 6 semester credit hours total

Choose any combination of 6 semester credit hours from the following:

Vocal/Instrumental Studies

[MUSI 3129](#) Applied Music

[MUSI 3229](#) Applied Music

[MUSI 3380](#) Guitar II

[MUSI 3382](#) Vocal Instruction II

[MUSI 3384](#) Best of Broadway

[MUSI 3387](#) Keyboard Skills for Contemporary Music

[MUSI 3388](#) Piano III

[MUSI 4344](#) Opera Workshop

[MUSI 4322](#) Vocal Instruction III

[MUSI 4345](#) Music Performance III

Music Ensembles

3000-level ensembles are generally offered in the fall semester; 4000-level ensembles are generally offered in the spring semester. Ensembles may be repeated for credit.

[MUSI 3112](#) Advanced Orchestra/Chamber Music Ensemble I

[MUSI 4112](#) Advanced Orchestra/Chamber Music Ensemble II

[MUSI 3116](#) Guitar Ensemble II

[MUSI 4116](#) Guitar Ensemble III

[MUSI 3118](#) String Orchestra II

[MUSI 4118](#) String Orchestra III

[MUSI 3120](#) Wind Ensemble II

[MUSI 4120](#) Wind Ensemble III

[MUSI 3122](#) Brass Ensemble I

[MUSI 3124](#) Harp Ensemble I

[MUSI 4124](#) Harp Ensemble II

[MUSI 3127](#) University Choir

[MUSI 3130](#) Percussion Ensemble

[MUSI 3131](#) Drumline

[MUSI 3181](#) Instrumental Ensemble II

[MUSI 3182](#) Collaborative Piano

[MUSI 4146](#) Instrumental Ensemble III

[MUSI 3185](#) Chamber Singers I

[MUSI 4185](#) Chamber Singers II

[MUSI 3186](#) Jazz Ensemble II

[MUSI 4186](#) Jazz Ensemble III

[MUSI 4V12](#) Chamber Music

[MUSI 4V13](#) Chamber Music II

1. A required Major Preparatory Course that also fulfills a Core Curriculum requirement. Semester credit hours may be counted in Core Curriculum.

2. Students may use only one lower-division music theory course for the minor

3. Music Theory level for Minor depends on successful placement evaluation and instructor approval

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